

Colonel John Munro, British Resident in Travancore and Cochin from 1810 to 1819, as well as serving as Dewan in both kingdoms from 1811 to 1814.

I have seen it written that John Munro introduced the worst of Travancore's punitive taxes. The records show the opposite, that Munro instituted a series of reforms to the existing system of taxation which reduced tax levels while at the same time bringing in increased revenue to the royal treasury.[12] He abolished inheritance tax, capitation tax and forced labour, and stripped revenue collectors of their former judicial powers. He introduced a policing network in the form of *thana*s and *darogah*s (police stations and police chiefs) and set up a modern judicial system with a central court of appeal and eight *zillah*s, local courts each presided over by a triumvirate of three judges – a Nair, a Brahmin and a Syrian Christian – all with good salaries and set rules 'to be regulated according to the Hindoo *shasters* and usages'. Munro should also be given credit for the royal